



With an eye on winning back power, the AIADMK's Jayalalithaa is now actively wooing allies who walked out on Karunanidhi.

But Higher Education Minister K. Ponmudi insists that the popularity of the party has not waned because of the many pro-people schemes that the Government has devised.

As charges fly thick in the air, Karunanidhi is aware of the precarious position of the DMK. The PMK has bid goodbye to the DMK-led DPA and keeping the speculation rife, PMK leader S. Ramadoss has said the party will make a final decision on the alliance only after the election dates are announced.

Such talks, meanwhile, has suited AIADMK leader J. Jayalalithaa who is all for courting disgruntled parties into her fold. When asked about an alliance with the Communists, she said, "If the Left parties can forge an alliance with the Congress, I don't see any problem in them to join hands with us." If the Left indeed leaves the DPA, the DMK will be left with only the Congress.

Much earlier, when some Congress leaders had asked for a berth in the state Cabinet, Karunanidhi had effectively doused such dreams. But the question is what would he do if the Congress wants a piece of the cake now. ■

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